Commodities Sentiment Report

2026-07-07 11:10 UTC

Previous edition: 2026-07-06 23:00 UTC. First edition in the RV-desk format: crowdedness scores (0-3), pair matrix with sentiment differentials, dated catalyst calendar, and positioning reads per leg.

COMMODITY	SENTIMENT	CROWD	Δ VS LAST	ONE-LINE DRIVER
Crude Oil (WTI/Brent)	-1 Leaning bearish	○○○ 0	unchanged	OPEC+ quota hike + $11 Aramco OSP cut vs LNG carrier struck near Hormuz
Natural Gas	-2 Bearish	○○○ 0	unchanged	Storage surplus + cool forecasts; crowd still leans bullish against the news
Gold	+1 Leaning bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Holding pattern into Wednesday's Fed minutes; labor-market tailwind intact
Silver	+2 Bullish	●●● 3	unchanged	Holding the rebound (~$62.75); most crowded bullish view on the board
Copper	+1 Leaning bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Narrow range; Fed repricing + China fund rotation, awaiting hard demand data
Wheat	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Structural supply story vs managed money extremely short and Sell technicals
Corn	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Holding one-month high on France damage + China framework
Soybeans	+1 Leaning bullish	○○○ 0	▲ from Neutral	Cofco booked 6+ US cargoes; five-week high $11.80 — the China tell triggered

Direction: −3 Very bearish → +3 Very bullish. Crowd: 0 two-sided → 3 crowded & uniform (contrarian risk). Sentiment reflects the tone of current news and trader coverage about the price outlook, not the last price move.

BIGGEST SHIFTS

Soybeans upgraded to Leaning bullish (+1) — the exact trigger flagged in prior editions fired: China's Cofco booked at least six cargoes of US soybeans for Sep-Oct shipment (on top of ~200kt already bought), under the summit agreement covering ≥25M tons annually through 2028, and beans hit a five-week high near $11.80. That narrows the corn-soybean sentiment spread from +2 to +1. Crude is now genuinely two-sided (crowd 0): OPEC+ raised quotas and Aramco cut its Arab Light OSP by $11 for Asia — aggressive supply-side bearishness — but a Qatari LNG carrier was struck by a projectile near Hormuz, reviving the war-risk bid and pushing WTI to a one-week high above $69. Watch that tension resolve.

RV pair matrix

Sentiment spread = leg1 − leg2; positive favors leg1 outperformance.

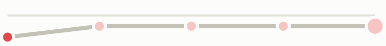
PAIR	SPREAD	Δ VS LAST	READ
gold − silver	-1	unchanged	News flow still favors silver beta, but silver is crowd-3 vs gold's crowd-1 — the differential is increasingly a positioning risk, not a fresh signal
corn − soybeans	+1	▼ from +2	**Narrowing.** Beans leg upgraded on real China cargoes; corn's edge now rests on France damage + US pollination weather alone
corn − wheat	0	unchanged	Both +2 but different engines: corn = demand + weather, wheat = structural supply. Wheat has the short-covering kicker if COT confirms
crude − natgas	+1	unchanged	Both bearish complexes; crude has the two-sided geopolitical tail (Hormuz), gas has the priced-in argument. Spread is a war-risk expression
gold − copper	0	unchanged	Same macro driver (Fed repricing) lifting both; no divergent signal until China data or Fed minutes split them

Catalyst calendar (next 7 days)

DATE	EVENT	LEGS	WHY IT MATTERS NOW
Tue Jul 7	API petroleum inventories (4:30pm ET)	crude	First read on whether the surplus narrative shows up in stocks
Wed Jul 8	FOMC minutes (2pm ET)	gold, silver, copper	The metals' entire tailwind is the ~50% Sept hike repricing; hawkish minutes hit crowd-3 silver hardest
Wed Jul 8	EIA Weekly Petroleum Status (10:30am ET)	crude	Confirms/denies API; a draw would strengthen the floor at $68-70
Thu Jul 9	EIA natural gas storage (10:30am ET)	natural-gas	Another >90 Bcf injection entrenches -2; a miss feeds the crowd's snap-back thesis
Thu Jul 9	USDA weekly export sales (8:30am ET)	wheat, corn, soybeans	**The** print for the beans upgrade — Cofco cargoes should start showing in the data
Fri Jul 10	CFTC COT (3:30pm ET)	all	Wheat is the one to check: are extreme managed-money shorts starting to cover?
Fri Jul 10	Baker Hughes rig count (1pm ET)	crude, natural-gas	Supply-side confirmation for both energy legs
Jul 10-12 window	USDA WASDE (date per USDA calendar)	wheat, corn, soybeans	First full balance-sheet update since the acreage shocks; verify exact date
Mon Jul 13	USDA Crop Progress (4pm ET)	corn, soybeans	Pollination-window condition scores — corn's weather premium lives or dies here

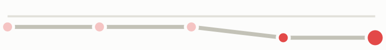
Score history (oldest → newest)

crude-oil



-2 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1

natural-gas



-1 → -1 → -1 → -2 → -2

gold

+1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1

silver	+1 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
copper	0 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1
wheat	+2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
corn	+1 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
soybeans	-1 → 0 → 0 → 0 → +1

Crude Oil (WTI / Brent) -1 Leaning bearish ○○○ 0

What's happening. The bear case escalated: OPEC+ agreed over the weekend to raise production quotas for next month, and Saudi Aramco cut its Arab Light OSP for Asia by $11/bbl to $1.50 *below* the regional benchmark — but a fully laden Qatari LNG carrier was struck by a projectile near the Omani coast exiting Hormuz, reviving doubts about the US-Iran agreement's durability and lifting WTI to a one-week high above $69 (Trading Economics, OilPrice, Fortune).

Social pulse. Bearish-but-buying-support: TradingView chatter still leans sell with retail bids clustered at $68-70 and stops below (TradingView Minds); some chatter now argues supply risks are again bigger than demand fears.

Positioning read. This is now a two-sided market (crowd 0) — shorts face headline risk from every Hormuz incident, longs face OPEC+ barrels and an OSP that screams weak Asian demand. The asymmetry: the supply bearishness is scheduled and priced, the geopolitical risk is not. Flat-price shorts should be smaller; the cleaner expression is relative (e.g. vs gas, or curve structure if the OSP cut drags spot). Wednesday's EIA is the next dated test.

Natural Gas -2 Bearish ○○○ 0

What's happening. Henry Hub steadied around $3.22-3.29 but the news basis is unchanged and bearish: storage 6.2% above average after the 87 Bcf build, production near record ~110 Bcf/d, and cooler July 7-16 forecasts (Trading Economics, Investing.com). The Hormuz LNG-carrier strike is a global gas story — it supports TTF/JKM and, at the margin, US LNG export demand (feedgas already ~17.3 Bcf/d).

Social pulse. *Still diverges bullish:* polls ~55-60% bullish on the "bearish news is priced in near multi-year lows" thesis (TradingView).

Positioning read. News says -2, crowd says fade it — which caps the risk/reward of fresh shorts down here. The LNG-security angle is the underpriced tail: if Hormuz incidents continue, global gas premiums pull US feedgas demand up while Henry Hub is priced for weather-driven softness. Thursday's EIA injection is the dated catalyst; a sub-consensus print plus any LNG headline flips this fast.

Gold +1 Leaning bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Gold consolidates around $4,140-4,166 after the dollar-driven pullback from two-week highs; the weak-payrolls repricing (Sept hike odds ~50%) still underpins, with Wednesday's FOMC minutes the gate (Trading Economics, Kitco).

Social pulse. Mixed-to-bullish; miner enthusiasm remains the hot spot while the metal itself has visible two-way chatter (TradingView Minds).

Positioning read. Gold is the lower-crowd way to hold the Fed-repricing view (crowd 1 vs silver's 3). Into the minutes, that's the trade-structure takeaway: if you want the dovish outcome, gold gives it with less crowd unwind risk; if the minutes read hawkish, gold should outperform silver on the way down (long gold/short silver as the hedge expression).

Silver **+2 Bullish** ●●● 3

What's happening. Silver holds ~$62.75 after the ~6% rebound off seven-month lows; safe-haven demand, the Warsh cooling-inflation comments and soft hiring data remain the cited drivers (Kitco, Trading Economics).

Social pulse. Uniformly bullish — retail accumulating dips, SLV gauge bullish while GLD sits bearish (StockTwits SLV). No meaningful bear case circulating: that uniformity is the crowd-3.

Positioning read. Direction +2, but this is the board's most crowded view, one macro print from an air pocket. Longs should be sized for a hawkish-minutes gap; the gold/silver ratio is the release valve (silver underperforms both directions of a shakeout). Fresh entries here are buying what the crowd already owns — wait for the minutes or buy the ratio dip.

Copper **+1 Leaning bullish** ●○○ 1

What's happening. Copper trades a narrow $6.15-6.25 range: Fed repricing supportive, Chinese funds rotating into metals ahead of H1 producer earnings, South American concentrate output dented — but no hard China demand print yet (Trading Economics, Investing.com).

Social pulse. Constructive; bank bull targets (Citi ~$14,500/t) still the most-shared item (TradingView news), with some caution on "premium levels" fading.

Positioning read. Copper is the un-crowded cyclical leg of the metals repricing — same macro driver as silver at crowd 1 instead of 3. China industrial data and mid-month trade numbers are the dated catalysts that would move it to +2; the Fed minutes are the shared risk with the precious legs (gold−copper spread stays 0 until one of those splits them).

Wheat **+2 Bullish** ●○○ 1

What's happening. Wheat consolidated (-0.7% to ~$6.02 after the surge) but the structural story keeps hardening: plantings 42.74M acres — lowest in USDA records back to 1919 — HRW crop smallest since 1957/58, June stocks below expectations; Black Sea production still caps the global balance (Trading Economics, USDA ERS).

Social pulse. The mood/money split sharpened: chatter now describes managed money *extremely* short with commercials aggressively long, while technical readings still lean Sell (TradingView wheat forums).

Positioning read. This is the board's clearest asymmetry: a strengthening supply narrative sitting on top of an extreme short base. If Friday's COT shows covering has begun, the squeeze can run well past fundamentals; the invalidator is aggressive Black Sea export offers undercutting US futures. Corn−wheat at 0 understates wheat's kicker — the spread expression is long wheat vs corn into the COT print if you want the squeeze without the outright weather risk.

Corn **+2 Bullish** ●○○ 1

What's happening. Corn holds its one-month high (~$4.27-4.30): France heat damage (~1/3 of crop), below-forecast US stocks (5.295B bu) and acreage (95.34M), and the US-China reciprocal tariff framework covering ag (Trading Economics, AgWeb).

Social pulse. Still lagging the headlines; cautious sideways framing dominates dated chatter (TradingView corn ideas). No contradicting signal.

Positioning read. Corn's +2 now leans harder on weather than it did yesterday — the China catalyst migrated to the beans leg (Cofco is booking beans, not corn, so far). Monday's Crop Progress and the mid-July pollination forecasts are the dated risk; the corn−soybean spread (+1 and narrowing) is the cleaner way to fade corn's weather premium if forecasts turn benign.

Soybeans **+1 Leaning bullish** ○○○ 0

What's happening. *Upgraded.* Beans hit a five-week high near $11.80: Cofco booked at least six US cargoes for Sep-Oct on top of ~200kt already bought, under the summit deal targeting ≥25M tons annually through 2028; above-normal mid-July temperatures add a weather kicker against improving rain prospects (Trading Economics, Barchart).

Social pulse. No fresh social signal — chatter hasn't caught up to the Cofco bookings (TradingView soybean ideas).

Positioning read. The demand leg the bear case rested on just showed up, and the crowd hasn't repriced it (crowd 0) — that's the freshest signal on the board. Thursday's export sales print is the dated confirmation; if the cargoes register and more follow, the corn−soybean spread keeps compressing and the outright can retest the big-stocks ceiling. Invalidator: bookings stall at token volumes while US weather turns benign.
